SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

20 July 2022 · Shift 3

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 24 questions

Q.1

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Discern
(B) Harrass
(C) Reppercusions
(D) Appealling

Q.2

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. I seen a beautiful dress in the market yesterday.

(A) I seen a
(B) the market yesterday
(C) beautiful dress in
(D) No error

Q.4

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Inception

(A) Termination
(B) Regression
(C) Launch
(D) Beginning

Q.5

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. It is a “benign” cyst and requires no treatment.

(A) Mellow
(B) Violent
(C) Delicate
(D) Gracious

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Unique

(A) Typical
(B) Regular
(C) Divine
(D) exclusive

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Barking up the wrong tree

(A) Pursue a course of action that will most likely be futile
(B) Make an enemy of someone
(C) Respectfully disagree with someone
(D) Pursue one's agenda

Q.8

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. They left the car by “the aside of the road and venture toward” the forest.

(A) the side of the road and ventured into
(B) the alongside of the road and ventured to
(C) an aside of road and ventured to
(D) No improvement required

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. His grandfather finds a tiny tiger cub in the forest and “brought his home.”

(A) brings it home
(B) bringing home
(C) bring it home
(D) No substitution required

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Success in any field depends _____ hard work and determination.

(A) with
(B) for
(C) on
(D) in

Q.11

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Add fuel to the fire

(A) Encourage someone to do right
(B) Add wrong ingredients
(C) To abuse someone
(D) Worsen an already bad situation

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Several pictures and videos have been circulating _____ social media featuring her.

(A) by
(B) of
(C) to
(D) on

Q.13

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. Mylar balloons cause power outages when they come of contact with power lines.

(A) Mylar balloons cause power outages
(B) with power lines
(C) when they come of contact
(D) No error

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Only 30 per cent worked in companies where paternity leave was an _____.

(A) Acknowledgement
(B) Entitlement
(C) Enforcement
(D) Employment

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. A nine-judge bench of the Supreme Court unanimously held that Indians have a/an _____ protected fundamental right to privacy.

(A) permeably
(B) constitutionally
(C) indigenously
(D) unethically

Q.16

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Enthrall

(A) Deceive
(B) Repulse
(C) Forgive
(D) Captivate

Q.17

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who is outspoken and outgoing

(A) Psychic
(B) Extrovert
(C) Heroic
(D) Flamboyant

Q.18

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Its always a / beautiful day / in my neighbourhood.

(A) beautiful day
(B) Its always a
(C) in my neighbourhood
(D) No error

Q.19

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The toast "will being ready" in about 15 minutes.

(A) are being ready
(B) No improvement required
(C) will been readily
(D) will be ready

Q.20

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Exclusion

(A) Discharge
(B) Commotion
(C) Wreck
(D) Admittance

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Apart from other pollutions, noise pollution – also known as environmental noise or sound pollution – is (1) _____ issue related to human beings and the environment. It may have an (2) _____ on general health. Compressors, generators and pipe handling are the (3) _____ of noise. Long-term (4) _____ to noise can (5) _____ a variety of health hazards.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) other
(B) another
(C) once
(D) one's

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Apart from other pollutions, noise pollution – also known as environmental noise or sound pollution – is (1) _____ issue related to human beings and the environment. It may have an (2) _____ on general health. Compressors, generators and pipe handling are the (3) _____ of noise. Long-term (4) _____ to noise can (5) _____ a variety of health hazards.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) impact
(B) issue
(C) problem
(D) interest

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Apart from other pollutions, noise pollution – also known as environmental noise or sound pollution – is (1) _____ issue related to human beings and the environment. It may have an (2) _____ on general health. Compressors, generators and pipe handling are the (3) _____ of noise. Long-term (4) _____ to noise can (5) _____ a variety of health hazards.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) rise
(B) effects
(C) sources
(D) original

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Apart from other pollutions, noise pollution – also known as environmental noise or sound pollution – is (1) _____ issue related to human beings and the environment. It may have an (2) _____ on general health. Compressors, generators and pipe handling are the (3) _____ of noise. Long-term (4) _____ to noise can (5) _____ a variety of health hazards.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) closure
(B) exposure
(C) safety
(D) vicinity

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Apart from other pollutions, noise pollution – also known as environmental noise or sound pollution – is (1) _____ issue related to human beings and the environment. It may have an (2) _____ on general health. Compressors, generators and pipe handling are the (3) _____ of noise. Long-term (4) _____ to noise can (5) _____ a variety of health hazards.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) record
(B) cause
(C) mould
(D) target

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.2

Which two numbers (not digits) should be interchanged to make the following equation correct? (4 × 12 + 15) ÷ 8 – 9 = 0

(A) 12 and 15
(B) 4 and 8
(C) 12 and 8
(D) 8 and 9

Q.3

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 21, 22, 44, 47, 188, ?

(A) 189
(B) 193
(C) 658
(D) 940

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. KNA : PMZ :: RSV : ?

(A) IHE
(B) IJE
(C) IJF
(D) IHF

Q.6

In a certain code language, 'ROM' is coded as '43', and 'ABK' is coded as '11'. How will 'PNB' be coded in that language?

(A) 31
(B) 29
(C) 30
(D) 32

Q.7

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) (18, 36, 72); (16, 32, 64)

(A) (24, 48, 96)
(B) (32, 96, 128)
(C) (14, 28, 54)
(D) (38, 76, 162)

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. ABC6 : DEF15 :: GHI24 : JKL33 :: PQR51 : ?

(A) STU60
(B) STU58
(C) TUV59
(D) TUV60

Q.9

In a certain code language, 'MK - SP' is coded as '–605', and 'AB - TF' is coded as '–194'. How will 'GM - HK' be coded in that language?

(A) –72
(B) –84
(C) –98
(D) –106

Q.12

Select the option that is related to the sixth number in the same way as the first number is related to the second number and the third number is related to the fourth number. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) 11 : 169 :: 13 : 225 :: ? : 361

(A) 17
(B) 19
(C) 21
(D) 15

Q.13

In a certain code language, 'COVER' is coded as '63', 'BASIS' is coded as '50', and 'WISH' is coded as '59'. How will 'GREECE' be coded in that language?

(A) 42
(B) 52
(C) 43
(D) 58

Q.15

Identify the number that does NOT belong to the following series. 16, 34, 52, 72, 88, 106

(A) 72
(B) 34
(C) 88
(D) 52

Q.16

Seven girls G1, G2, G3, G4, G5, G6 and G7 are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (not necessarily in the same order). G6 is second to the left of G1. G7 is second to the left of G6. G5 is third to the right of G2. G5 is not the immediate neighbour of G6. G4 is third to the right of G3. Who is second to the left of G7?

(A) G2
(B) G1
(C) G4
(D) G3

Q.17

Among seven friends Akash, Biraj, Chandan, Dharmesh, Imran, Faisal and Gautam, Biraj is taller than only Dharmesh. Only one person is taller than Faisal. The height of exactly two friends lies in between that of Akash and Chandan. Imran is taller than Gautam. Who is the third tallest person in the group?

(A) Gautam
(B) Imran
(C) Faisal
(D) Dharmesh

Q.18

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. YZ, BCD, FGHI, ?, QRSTUV

(A) JKLMN
(B) LMNOP
(C) KLMNO
(D) JKLM

Q.19

M, N, O, P and Q are standing in a queue to place their order in a restaurant. Only P is standing between M and Q. O is ahead of only N. Who is standing second in the line if there is no other person in the queue?

(A) O
(B) P
(C) Q
(D) M

Q.20

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '×' and '–' are interchanged and also '+' and '÷' are interchanged? 40 + 10 – 5 × 4 ÷ 5 = ?

(A) 24
(B) 22
(C) 28
(D) 21

Q.21

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. Some cars are bikes. II. No truck is a car. Conclusions: I. All trucks are bikes. II. All bikes are cars. III. All cars are trucks.

(A) None of the conclusions follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Only conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusions II and III follow

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. MJO : NQQ :: TRA : ?

(A) GIC
(B) HIB
(C) HIC
(D) GIB

Q.23

In a certain code language, 'ACCIDENT' is written as 'JDDBUOFE', 'ABSOLUTE' is written as 'PTCBFUVM', and 'ACCURATE' is written as 'VDDBFUBS'. How will 'SENTENCE' be written in that language?

(A) GHJKSDFT
(B) TNESDDND
(C) UOFTFDOF
(D) UFPTEDOE

Q.25

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. No X is G. II. All B are X. Conclusions: I. Some G are B. II. All X are B.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) None of the conclusions follow
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Only conclusion I follows

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

The Tamil Nadu coast gets a large portion of its rain during _____.

(A) October and November
(B) August and September
(C) December and January
(D) February and March

Q.2

The government budget gives a statement of the _____.

(A) receipts and expenditure of the government
(B) developments in the Indian economy
(C) receipts of the government only
(D) expenditure of the government only

Q.3

_____ is known as the energy currency of the cell.

(A) DNA
(B) ADP
(C) ATP
(D) RNA

Q.4

Earthworm belongs to which group of animal kingdom?

(A) Annelida
(B) Mollusca
(C) Arthropoda
(D) Nematoda

Q.5

Who among the following has received the prestigious Bharat Ratna Dr Ambedkar Award 2021?

(A) Sana Saeed
(B) Harshaali Malhotra
(C) Arjun Rampal
(D) Jagannath Nivangune

Q.6

An alliance formed by political parties after elections when no party has been able to get adequate seats to form a clear majority is called _____.

(A) coalition
(B) appropriation
(C) allegiance
(D) prorogation

Q.7

According to the Indian Constitution, all are fundamental rights, EXCEPT:

(A) right against exploitation
(B) right to property
(C) right to equality
(D) right to freedom

Q.8

_____ in Gujarat was the emporium of western trade during the Mughal Period.

(A) Navsari
(B) Narmada
(C) Porbandar
(D) Surat

Q.9
Manish Pandey played for which team in IPL 2022?

(A) Sunrisers Hyderabad
(B) Lucknow Super Giants
(C) Gujarat Titans
(D) Delhi Capitals

Q.10
In November 2021, who launched Tejasvini and Hausala schemes in Jammu?

(A) Rajnath Singh
(B) Nirmala Sitharaman
(C) Narendra Modi
(D) Amit Shah

Q.11
Nati is a folk dance of which Indian state?

(A) Himachal Pradesh
(B) Bihar
(C) Kerala
(D) Nagaland

Q.12
According to the Census of India 2011, among all the states/UTs Kerala occupied the _____ position in terms of literacy.

(A) fifth
(B) third
(C) second
(D) first

Q.13
Megasthenes, an ambassador, was sent to the court of _____ by the Greek ruler of West Asia, Seleucus Nicator.

(A) Bindusara
(B) Chandragupta
(C) Samprati
(D) Ashoka

Q.14
Who wrote the book 'Gulamgiri'?

(A) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(B) Narayana Guru
(C) Jyotirao Phule
(D) Ghasidas

Q.15
Mrinalini Sarabhai is known for which of the following classical dance forms?

(A) Bharatanatyam and Kathak
(B) Kathak and Kathakali
(C) Bharatanatyam and Kathakali
(D) Kathak and Odissi

Q.16
In India, which organisation is responsible for collecting data related to unemployment?

(A) NITI Aayog
(B) Securities and Exchange Board of India
(C) National Sample Survey Organisation
(D) Planning Commission

Q.17
What is the atomic number of hydrogen in the Mendeleev's periodic table?

(A) 1
(B) 11
(C) 5
(D) 15

Q.18
Who among the following Mughal rulers built the Agra Fort?

(A) Babur
(B) Shahjahan
(C) Jahangir
(D) Akbar

Q.19
Which of the following festivals is associated with Arunachal Pradesh?

(A) Pongal
(B) Ugadi
(C) Wangala
(D) Solung

Q.20
Which of the following football teams won the Indian Super League 2021-2022?

(A) Kerala Blasters FC
(B) ATK Mohun Bagan FC
(C) Mumbai City FC
(D) Hyderabad FC

Q.21
Which of the following Indian rivers is also referred to as 'Dakshin Ganga'?

(A) Godavari River
(B) Krishna River
(C) Sutlej River
(D) Mahanadi River

Q.22
According to their capacity, roads are classified into how many classes in India?

(A) Five
(B) Nine
(C) Six
(D) Three

Q.23
Who is the author of the book 'A Suitable Boy'?

(A) Vikram Seth
(B) Devdutt Pattanaik
(C) Khushwant Singh
(D) Arundhati Roy

Q.24
With which musical instrument is Hariprasad Chaurasia associated?

(A) Sitar
(B) Flute
(C) Tabla
(D) Santoor

Q.25
In which year did Mahatma Gandhi arrive in India from South Africa?

(A) 1911
(B) 1909
(C) 1913
(D) 1915

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**
Q.9 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**
Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (A) Discern

'Discern' is spelt correctly. The others should be 'harass', 'repercussions' and 'appealing'.

Q.2 · Answer (A) I seen a

'Yesterday' calls for the simple past: 'I saw a beautiful dress'. 'Seen' is a past participle and cannot stand without 'have'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Termination

'Inception' is the beginning of something, so its opposite is 'termination', the end. 'Launch' and 'beginning' mean much the same as 'inception'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Violent

'Benign' means gentle or harmless (a benign cyst is not cancerous), so of the options its opposite is 'violent'. 'Mellow' and 'gracious' are close to it in meaning.

Q.6 · Answer (D) exclusive

'Unique' means being the only one of its kind, or belonging to one alone: what is unique to a place is exclusive to it. 'Typical' and 'regular' are nearly its opposites.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Pursue a course of action that will most likely be futile

To be 'barking up the wrong tree' is to follow a mistaken idea or course of action, one that will get nowhere.

Q.8 · Answer (A) the side of the road and ventured into

A car is left 'by the side of the road' ('aside' is an adverb, not a noun), and 'left' needs the past 'ventured' to match: 'ventured into the forest'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) brings it home

The second verb must match 'finds' in tense, so 'brings', and the pronoun for the cub is 'it': 'and brings it home'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) on

'Depend' takes 'on': success depends on hard work and determination.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Worsen an already bad situation

To 'add fuel to the fire' is to make an already bad situation worse.

Q.12 · Answer (D) on

Posts and videos circulate 'on' social media, as they appear on a platform.

Q.13 · Answer (C) when they come of contact

The phrase is 'come into contact with': 'when they come into contact with power lines'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Entitlement

An 'entitlement' is something one has a right to: in those companies paternity leave was the employees' right.

Q.15 · Answer (B) constitutionally

A fundamental right is guaranteed by the Constitution, so it is 'constitutionally' protected. 'Permeably', 'indigenously' and 'unethically' make no sense here.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Captivate

To 'enthrall' is to hold someone's attention completely: to 'captivate'. 'Repulse' is nearly its opposite.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Extrovert

An extrovert is an outgoing, sociable person who speaks freely. 'Flamboyant' means showy, and a psychic claims powers beyond the senses.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Its always a

'Its' is the possessive; the short form of 'it is' is 'it's': 'It's always a beautiful day'.

Q.19 · Answer (D) will be ready

The modal 'will' is followed by the bare infinitive: 'The toast will be ready in about 15 minutes.'

Q.20 · Answer (D) Admittance

'Exclusion' is keeping someone out; its opposite is 'admittance', letting someone in.

Q.21 · Answer (B) another

'Apart from other pollutions', noise pollution is 'another' issue; 'another' goes with a singular noun such as 'issue'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) impact

Noise may have an 'impact', an effect, on general health; 'an issue on' or 'an interest on' health makes no sense.

Q.23 · Answer (C) sources

Compressors, generators and pipe handling are where the noise comes from: its 'sources'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) exposure

'Exposure to noise' is being subjected to it; long-term exposure is what harms health.

Q.25 · Answer (B) cause

Long-term exposure can 'cause', that is bring about, a variety of health hazards.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.2 · Answer (A) 12 and 15

Interchanging 12 and 15: $(4 \times 15 + 12) \div 8 - 9 = 72 \div 8 - 9 = 9 - 9 = 0$.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 193

The steps are +1, ×2, +3, ×4, +5: 21 + 1 = 22, 22 × 2 = 44, 44 + 3 = 47, 47 × 4 = 188 and 188 + 5 = 193.

Q.5 · Answer (A) IHE

Each letter is replaced by its opposite in the alphabet (A↔Z, B↔Y and so on): K → P, N → M, A → Z. So R → I, S → H, V → E: IHE.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 29

The code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet minus 3: ROM = 18 + 15 + 13 = 46 and 46 − 3 = 43; ABK = 1 + 2 + 11 = 14 and 14 − 3 = 11. PNB = 16 + 14 + 2 = 32, and 32 − 3 = 29.

Q.7 · Answer (A) (24, 48, 96)

In each set every number is double the one before: 18, 36, 72 and 16, 32, 64. Likewise 24, 48, 96. In the others 32 × 3 = 96, 28 × 2 = 56 and 76 × 2 = 152 break the pattern.

Q.8 · Answer (A) STU60

Each cluster is followed by the next three letters, and the number is the sum of the letters' places: DEF = 4 + 5 + 6 = 15 and JKL = 10 + 11 + 12 = 33. After PQR come STU, with 19 + 20 + 21 = 60: STU60.

Q.9 · Answer (C) –98

Each pair of letters is written as their places in the alphabet side by side, and the second number is subtracted from the first: MK - SP → 1311 − 1916 = −605 and AB - TF → 12 − 206 = −194. So GM - HK → 713 − 811 = −98.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 17

Each first number plus 2, squared, gives the second: $(11 + 2)^2 = 169$ and $(13 + 2)^2 = 225$. As $361 = 19^2$, the missing number is 19 − 2 = 17.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 43
Each word is coded as the sum of its letters' places in the alphabet: COVER = 3 + 15 + 22 + 5 + 18 = 63, BASIS = 50 and WISH = 59. GREECE = 7 + 18 + 5 + 5 + 3 + 5 = 43.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 72
The terms should rise by 18: 16, 34, 52, 70, 88, 106. 72 does not fit; it should be 70.

Q.16 · Answer (D) G3
Facing the centre, a person's left is the next seat clockwise. Numbering the seats clockwise from G1 (seat 1), G6 is in seat 3 and G7 in seat 5; G5, three seats anticlockwise of G2, must be in seat 6 with G2 in seat 2 (the only other fit, G2 in seat 7, puts G5 in seat 4 beside G6), and G4, three seats anticlockwise of G3, is in seat 4 with G3 in seat 7. Second to the left of G7 is seat 7: G3.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Imran
Biraj is taller than only Dharmesh, so they are sixth and seventh, and Faisal is second. Akash and Chandan, with exactly two between them, can only be first and fourth, leaving third and fifth for Imran and Gautam; Imran is the taller, so he is third.

Q.18 · Answer (C) KLMNO
Each cluster has one letter more than the last, and one letter is skipped between clusters: YZ, (A) BCD, (E) FGHI, (J) KLMNO, (P) QRSTUV.

Q.19 · Answer (B) P
O is ahead of only N, so N is fifth and O fourth. M, P and Q take the first three places with P between M and Q, so P is second.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 21
After interchanging the signs: 40 ÷ 10 × 5 – 4 + 5 = 4 × 5 – 4 + 5 = 20 – 4 + 5 = 21.

Q.21 · Answer (A) None of the conclusions follow
No truck is a car, so no car is a truck and III is false. Nothing links trucks to bikes, and only some bikes are known to be cars, so neither I nor II follows.

Q.22 · Answer (A) GIC
The first two letters become their opposites in the alphabet (M → N, J → Q) and the third moves two places on (O → Q). So T → G, R → I and A → C: GIC.

Q.23 · Answer (C) UOFTFDOF
Each word is split into two halves of four letters; each letter moves one place on and each half is reversed: ACCI → BDDJ → JDDB and DENT → EFOU → UOFE. So SENT → TFOU → UOFT and ENCE → FODF → FDOF: UOFTFDOF.

Q.25 · Answer (B) None of the conclusions follow
All B are X and no X is G, so no B is G: I is false. Not every X need be a B, so II does not follow either.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) October and November
The Tamil Nadu coast gets much of its rain in October and November, from the retreating (north-east) monsoon, whose winds pick up moisture over the Bay of Bengal.

Q.2 · Answer (A) receipts and expenditure of the government
The budget, the Annual Financial Statement under Article 112, sets out the government's estimated receipts and expenditure for the year.

Q.3 · Answer (C) ATP
ATP (adenosine triphosphate) stores the energy released in respiration and supplies it to the cell's activities, hence 'energy currency'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Annelida
The earthworm is a segmented worm of the phylum Annelida, as is the leech. Snails are molluscs, insects arthropods and roundworms nematodes.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Harshaali Malhotra
Harshaali Malhotra, who played Munni in 'Bajrangi Bhaijaan' (2015) as a child, was presented the Bharat Ratna Dr Ambedkar Award by Maharashtra's Governor, Bhagat Singh Koshyari, at Raj Bhavan, Mumbai, in January 2022.

Q.6 · Answer (A) coalition
A coalition is an alliance of parties that together command a majority. Prorogation ends a session of the legislature, and allegiance is loyalty.

Q.7 · Answer (B) right to property
The 44th Amendment (1978) removed the right to property from the fundamental rights; it is now a constitutional right under Article 300A. The rights to equality, to freedom and against exploitation remain fundamental rights.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Surat
In the Mughal period Surat was the chief port of western trade, the gateway for trade with West Asia through the Persian Gulf, and the port from which pilgrim ships sailed for Mecca.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Lucknow Super Giants
Lucknow Super Giants, one of the two new teams in IPL 2022, bought Manish Pandey at the February 2022 auction; he had played for Sunrisers Hyderabad before.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Nirmala Sitharaman
Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman launched both at a credit outreach programme at the University of Jammu on 23 November 2021: Tejasvini gives young women up to ₹5 lakh to set up their own ventures, and Hausala supports existing women entrepreneurs.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Himachal Pradesh
Nati, danced in a line or circle at fairs and festivals in districts such as Kullu, is the best-known folk dance of Himachal Pradesh.

Q.12 · Answer (D) first
Census 2011 put Kerala's literacy rate at about 94%, the highest of all the states and Union Territories, with Lakshadweep second.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Chandragupta
Seleucus Nicator sent Megasthenes as his envoy to Chandragupta Maurya's court at Pataliputra; his account of India is known as the 'Indica'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Jyotirao Phule
'Gulamgiri' (Slavery), published in 1873, is Jyotirao Phule's attack on caste oppression; the same year he founded the Satyashodhak Samaj.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Bharatanatyam and Kathakali
Mrinalini Sarabhai trained in Bharatanatyam and Kathakali, and in 1949 founded the Darpana Academy of Performing Arts in Ahmedabad.

Q.16 · Answer (C) National Sample Survey Organisation
The National Sample Survey Organisation ran India's employment and unemployment surveys, including the Periodic Labour Force Survey from 2017; in 2019 it became part of the National Statistical Office.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 1
Mendeleev ordered the elements by atomic mass (atomic numbers came later), but hydrogen, the lightest, stood first in his table, and its atomic number is 1: one proton in its nucleus.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Akbar
Akbar built the red sandstone Agra Fort from 1565; Shah Jahan later added white-marble buildings inside it.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Solung
Solung is the agricultural festival of the Adi people of Arunachal Pradesh. Wangala is a Garo festival of Meghalaya, Pongal is celebrated in Tamil Nadu, and Ugadi is the new year in Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Karnataka.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Hyderabad FC
Hyderabad FC won the 2021-22 Indian Super League, beating Kerala Blasters on penalties in the final in Goa in March 2022.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Godavari River
The Godavari, the longest river of peninsular India, is called the Dakshin Ganga (Ganga of the south) for its length and the area it drains.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Six
NCERT classifies India's roads by capacity into six classes: the Golden Quadrilateral super highways, national highways, state highways, district roads, other (rural) roads and border roads.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Vikram Seth
'A Suitable Boy' (1993), a long novel set in newly independent India, is by Vikram Seth.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Flute
Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia is a master of the bansuri, the bamboo flute.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 1915
Gandhi returned from South Africa to Bombay on 9 January 1915, the day now marked as Pravasi Bharatiya Divas.

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